



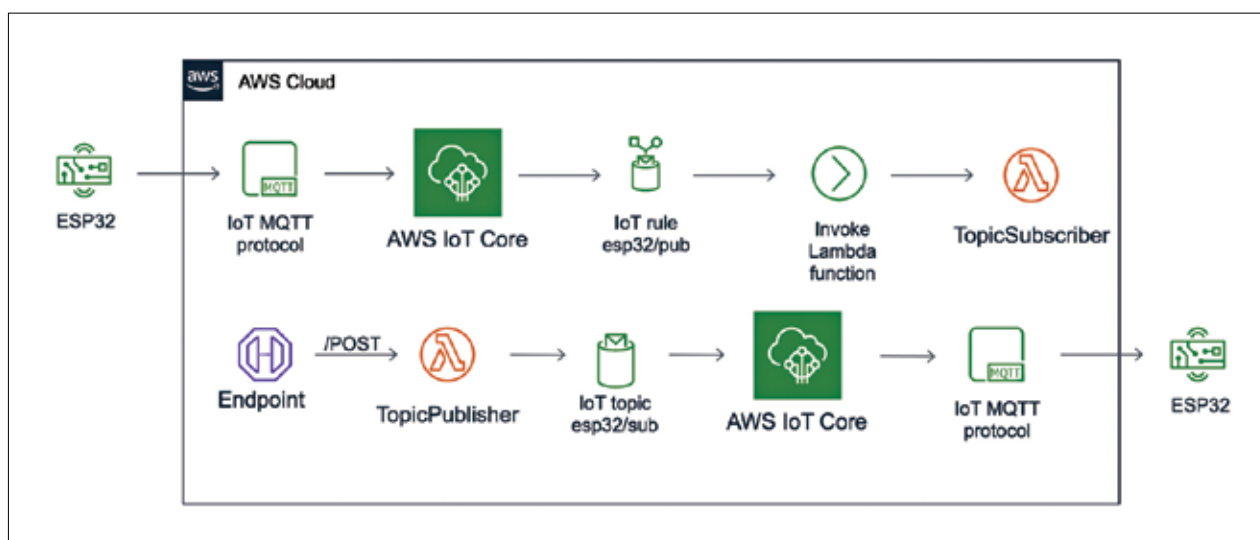
Talon: Hands-free coding

Software that lets you use dictation and eye-tracking to write code.
<http://dgit.in/nov20-71>



An ancient relic

Here's an old video of Bill Gates demonstrating Visual Basic in 1991.
<http://dgit.in/nov20-72>



manage massive caches of data and perform various operations on them using any of the AWS services such as Lambda, Kinesis and QuickSight. Going with a big provider like AWS also means that security will be baked into the ecosystem at every level making it ideal for applications that require a high grade of security.

DEVICEHIVE

Moving away from large IoT service providers, we come to the open-source offerings. DeviceHive is one such open-source platform which allows you to communicate and manage your IoT devices. The software stack is quite simple from an architecture perspective and has a wide assortment of libraries available



to perform multiple functions such as sensor data ingesting, telemetry, remote controlling devices and monitoring them all, in general.

It's a scalable platform that's hardware and cloud agnostic which means you aren't tied to any of the big providers and you should be able to switch from one provider to another quite easily. There are even provisions to take the data ingested

and feed the same to an AI model to generate insights. DeviceHive supports REST, Websocket API and MQTT for communication.

THINGER.IO

Scaling down to hobbyist levels, we arrive at Thinger.io which is an open-source platform that's easy to deploy and get started with. It



supports many of the popular dev boards based on ARM and Atmega microcontrollers so you shouldn't have any trouble with all the popular offerings on the market. It includes support for iOS and Android smartphone apps so you can build projects and control them in the same manner as most consumer grade smart devices. Also, it has support for IFTTT event triggers so you can get more done without having to manually code functions.

Thinger is also quite scalable and offers paid plans which are basically built upon AWS, GCP, Azure and Digital Ocean.

ZETTA

If you're a fan of node.js then Zetta might be the platform that you're

looking for. It's an API-oriented open-source framework designed for applications where data streams are expected to be continuous. Zetta combined REST APIs, WebSockets and reactive programming to serve applications with data streaming and real time processing. Zetta is also network protocol agnostic, so if you were to switch between protocols, you wouldn't have to modify your code base extensively.

These were some of the IoT platforms that we've had our eyes on. There are many others such as Mainflux, OpenRemote, Things-Speak, etc. that we haven't touched upon but are equally versatile as the platforms we've mentioned. Between the ones we've covered you could develop IoT projects that range from a simple home automation project to a multinational logistics enter-



prise. The best part is that a lot of the platforms are open-source and gaining popularity by the day. So if at all you're planning on starting an IoT project, then the barrier for entry has never been lower. 